

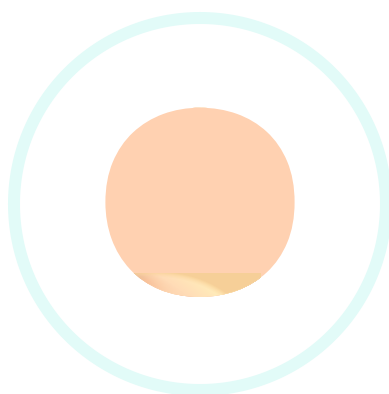


The Khan Family & Cookbook

recipes, memories & a little chaos

in the kitchen, together

A collection by **Noor & Yahya Khan**



Breads & Bakes

Warm from the tawa or the oven.

Munshi *Naan*

from the kitchen of Yahya

MAKES 4 • RISE 60–90 MIN • COOK 2–3 MIN EACH

Soft, pillowy, and weighed to the gram. The yogurt is what keeps the crumb tender instead of bready, and the ghee off the heat gives it that glossy, restaurant-style finish. Measured, not guessed — so it comes out the same every time.

a photo of the naan goes here ♦

fresh off the tava

INGREDIENTS

All-Purpose Flour	240 g	Warm Milk (or water)	120 g
Active Dry Yeast (Khamir)	3 g	Salt	4.5 g
Sugar	4 g	Plain Yogurt	30 g
		Ghee (or melted butter)	14 g

Milk warm, not hot — ~105°F (40°C). Above 115°F (46°C) kills the yeast.

METHOD

- 1 **Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm milk (120 g, ~105°F / 40°C). Stand 5–10 min until foamy. No foam means dead yeast — start over.
- 2 **Mix.** Combine flour (240 g) and salt (4.5 g). Add the yogurt (30 g), ghee (14 g) and the yeast milk. Mix to a shaggy dough.
- 3 **Knead.** 8–10 min by hand (or 5 min in a stand mixer on medium) until smooth, soft and slightly tacky. It should spring back when pressed.
- 4 **First rise.** Cover and rest in a warm spot 60–90 min, until doubled.
- 5 **Divide & shape.** Knock back, divide into 4 equal pieces (~102 g each). Ball them, cover, rest 10 min so the gluten relaxes.
- 6 **Roll.** Roll or stretch each into a teardrop ~8 in long, ~1/4 in thick.
- 7 **Cook hot.** Screaming-hot cast-iron skillet or tava, 2–3 min total — flip once big bubbles form and the underside is charred in spots.
- 8 **Finish.** Brush with extra ghee straight off the heat. Keep wrapped in a towel until serving so they stay soft.

Yahya's note: weigh everything. The yogurt is not optional — it is what makes the crumb tender. If the dough fights the roll, let it rest another 5 min; relaxed gluten rolls thin without tearing.

Everyday *Loaf*

from the kitchen of Yahya

1 STANDARD LOAF • RISE 2 HRS • BAKE 30–35 MIN • 375°F (190°C)

The dough that does everything. Built on a baker's formula at 64% hydration — soft enough for sandwiches, sturdy enough to shape free-form. The percentages are by weight of flour, so scale it up or down and it stays true.

a photo of the loaf goes here ♦

deep golden, cooled on a rack

FORMULA • 1 LOAF

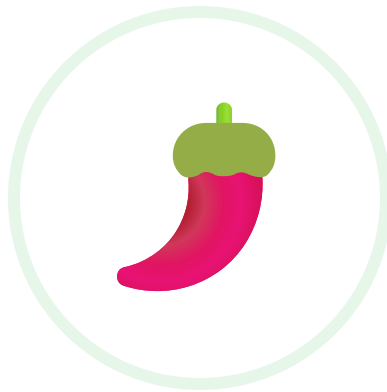
Flour (AP or bread)	375 g • 100%	Sugar (or Honey)	12 g • 3.2%
Water (warm)	240 g • 64%	Salt	9 g • 2.4%
Butter or Oil	14 g • 3.7%	Active Dry Yeast	7 g • 1.9%
Total Dough		657 g • 175.2%	

Hydration = water ÷ flour × 100 = 64%. Aim for a final dough temp of 76–78°F (24–26°C) — adjust water temp to hit it.

METHOD

- 1 **Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast (7 g) and sugar (12 g) into the warm water (240 g). Rest 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 **Mix.** Combine flour (375 g) and salt (9 g). Add the yeast water and butter or oil (14 g). Mix to a rough, shaggy dough.
- 3 **Knead.** 10 min by hand (or 6–7 min in a stand mixer on medium) until smooth and elastic — it should pass a windowpane test.
- 4 **Bulk rise.** Cover and ferment ~1 hr at warm room temperature, until doubled.
- 5 **Shape.** Gently degas, shape into a tight loaf, seam-side down in a greased 9×5 in pan (or free-form on a tray).
- 6 **Proof.** Cover and proof 45–60 min, until the dough crowns ~1 in above the rim and springs back slowly when poked.
- 7 **Bake.** 375°F (190°C) for 30–35 min, until deep golden and the internal temperature reads 200–205°F (93–96°C).
- 8 **Cool.** Turn out and cool on a rack at least 1 hr before slicing — cutting hot bread gums the crumb.

Yahya's note: the loaf is done when the thermometer says so, not when the timer rings. 64% hydration is forgiving — wetter for a more open crumb, drier for tidy sandwich slices, but weigh it either way.



Chutneys

The little jars that carry the meal.

Palak *Ulikaram*

from the kitchen of Noor

A BIG BOWL FOR THE FAMILY • A LAZY, TANGY AFTERNOON DISH

Spinach cooked down with a tangy, garlicky Andhra masala — roasted chilies and coriander ground with tamarind and a whole lot of garlic, then simmered into the greens until the oil comes shining back to the top. Eat it with hot white rice and a spoon of ghee, and don't count the garlic cloves.

a photo of the palak ulikaram goes here ♦

dark, glossy, and ready for rice

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE GROUND MASALA

- 1 big onion, roughly chopped
- a whole lot of garlic — a fistful of cloves
- a lime-sized ball of tamarind
- a good handful of dried red chilies
- 2–3 spoons whole coriander seeds (dhania)
- a spoon of cumin (zira)
- salt, to taste

FOR THE TEMPERING & GREENS

- oil, a generous pour
- mustard seeds & cumin (zira)
- chana dal & urad dal, a spoon each
- a sprig of curry leaves
- a pinch of asafoetida (hing)
- red chili powder, to your bravery
- turmeric (haldi), a good pinch
- lots & lots of spinach, finely chopped
- chopped coriander leaves, to finish
- ghee, for serving

Amounts are by feel — start with more garlic and chili than seems wise, then taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 **Roast the whole spices.** Lightly dry-sauté the dried red chilies, coriander seeds and cumin in a pan until they smell warm and toasty — just fragrant, don't burn them.
- 2 **Grind the masala.** Into the blender goes the onion, all that garlic, the tamarind, salt and your roasted chilies, coriander and cumin. Blend to a coarse paste — some texture is good.
- 3 **Start the tempering.** Heat a generous pour of oil until hot. Add mustard seeds, cumin, chana dal, urad dal and the curry leaves — let it splutter and the dals turn golden. Add a pinch of asafoetida.
- 4 **Fry the paste.** Tip in the ground masala and fry for a few minutes, stirring, until it darkens and the oil separates out at the edges.
- 5 **Spice it.** Add red chili powder, turmeric and a little more salt if it needs it. Give it a stir.
- 6 **Cook down the spinach.** Now add lots and lots of chopped spinach. Cook it and cook it and cook it — until all the water has gone and the oil separates again. That's how you know.
- 7 **Finish.** Stir through chopped coriander leaves. Serve with hot white rice and a spoon of ghee.

Amma's note: the whole secret is patience at the end — keep cooking the spinach until the oil comes back. Rushing it leaves it watery. And really, add more garlic than you think.



Seafood

From the coast, cooked with care.

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

from the kitchen of Noor

A PLATEFUL OF PRAWNS · QUICK FRY, BIG FLAVOUR

Prawns marinated in a pickle-spiced masala, then fried till they catch at the edges. The spoonful of achar — mango, tomato, whatever's open in the fridge — is the trick: it gives the whole thing that tangy, pickly kick. Wonderful with rice and dal, or just rice and a bit of chutney.

a photo of the jhinga fry goes here ♦

crisp at the edges, curry leaves and all

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE PRAWNS & MARINADE

- prawns (jhinga), heads & tails removed, washed
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- salt (namak), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania) — a little extra
- cumin powder (jeera)
- kalonji (black seeds)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- a spoon of achar — mango, tomato or mixed-veg pickle

FOR FRYING & FINISHING

- oil, for a hot shallow fry
- a sprig of curry leaves
- chopped coriander leaves, to garnish

Any pickle you have works — the achar is what makes it "achari." Start with a small spoon and taste.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 **Prep the prawns.** Remove the heads and tails, then wash the prawns well and drain.
- 2 **Marinate.** Add ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, chili powder, salt, a little extra coriander powder and cumin powder. Then add the kalonji (black seeds) and cumin seeds.
- 3 **The achari touch.** Stir in a spoon of whatever achar you have — mango, tomato or mixed-veg pickle. Mix well and let it marinate a while.
- 4 **Heat the oil.** Get the oil hot in a pan and drop in the curry leaves to let them crackle.
- 5 **Fry the prawns.** Lay the prawns in one by one and fry — turning — until they're cooked through and catching at the edges.
- 6 **Finish.** Garnish with chopped coriander leaves. Serve hot with rice and dal, or rice and chutney.

Amma's note: don't crowd the pan — lay the prawns in one by one so they fry, not steam. And don't overcook them; prawns are done the moment they curl and turn opaque.